What My 'Relentless' Tattoo Means

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 31, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/iX_irX2v5MQ Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter explains his 'Relentless' tattoo to his son, connecting the word's meaning to their family's ancestral history of escaping slavery through the Underground Railroad with Harriet Tubman.

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🔤 The Tattoo and Its Meaning 0:00

- Brandon has the word **"Relentless"** tattooed on his arm
  - His son read the tattoo aloud and asked what it meant
  - Brandon's definition to his son: "It means never give up, no matter what happens"
    - "You keep going until you win, until you claim victory, no matter how hard things get"
- His son's immediate response: "I am relentless"
  - Brandon affirmed him: "That's right, you are — because you're a Carter"

🧬 Family Legacy and Ancestry 0:24

- Brandon frames relentlessness as something inherited, not just chosen
  - "It's in your blood. It's in your DNA. You inherited it."
  - He describes his son as coming from "a long line of relentless men"
- The Carter family history is rooted in slavery
  - Rather than remaining enslaved — which Brandon calls the path of cowards — their ancestors chose to risk everything and flee

✊ The Ancestors Who Escaped 0:24

- The family's ancestors escaped slavery with **Harriet Tubman** via the Underground Railroad
  - They fled to **Chicago**, where they obtained their freedom
  - Brandon emphasizes they "risked everything" to make that choice

- He describes these ancestors as men and women who refused to remain in chains
  - They chose death over a life of enslavement

    > "They were relentless — just like your father, and just like you."

- The tattoo is therefore both a personal motto and a tribute to generational courage passed down through the family